



IN CONTEXT

GENRE

British New Wave

DIRECTOR

Karel Reisz

WRITER

Alan Sillitoe

STARS

Albert Finney, Shirley Anne Field, Rachel Roberts

BEFORE

1947 Robert Hamer's *It Always Rains on Sunday*, a gritty tale set in London's East End, is a precursor of the British realist dramas.

1959 *Look Back in Anger*, directed by Tony Richardson and based on a play by John Osborne, is the first British "kitchen sink" drama movie.

AFTER

1965 Starting with his TV docudrama *Up the Junction*, Ken Loach makes a series of movies mixing working-class drama with documentary.

THAT'S WHAT ALL THESE LOONY LAWS ARE FOR, TO BE BROKEN BY BLOKES LIKE US

SATURDAY NIGHT AND SUNDAY MORNING / 1960

Karel Reisz's *Saturday Night and Sunday Morning* brought working-class Britain to the screens in a way that had never been seen before. Based on a semiautobiographical novel by Alan Sillitoe, who also wrote the screenplay, the movie focuses on the story of young Arthur, who wants more out of life than a factory job. This was one of the first British movies to focus on the working

class not as victims, but as individuals with their own aspirations and frustrations. Reisz was a leader of the British New Wave of filmmakers that paralleled the French New Wave. Both

Doreen and Arthur meet in secret. While they rebel against their parents, whom they consider "dead from the neck up," they are not immune to reality when Arthur gets another girl pregnant.

